



Physics 1 Honors

CPALMS 2003388 | Grade 9–12 | Fall Semester | 5 Days/Week | 250 min/week

Family
Course
Overview

Note for Families: This overview reflects the planned course structure. Specific assignments, pacing, and assessments may be adjusted by your teacher. Always refer to your Canvas course for the most current information.

Physics 1 Honors is a full-year course designed for students who want a deeper and more challenging study of the physical world. Compared with regular Physics 1, the honors course moves at a faster pace with greater emphasis on critical thinking, multi-step problem solving, and connecting concepts across topics. This semester covers kinematics, Newton’s Laws, momentum, energy, heat, and gravitation with increased rigor consistent with Florida’s honors expectations.

Semester at a Glance

Quarter 1 — Weeks 1–9

- Wk 1** Motion and Kinematics: Position, Speed, and Velocity
- Wk 2** Acceleration, Motion Graphs, and Multi-Step Problems
- Wk 3** Interpreting and Applying Kinematics Concepts
- Wk 4** Forces and Newton’s Laws: Foundations
- Wk 5** Newton’s Laws Applied: Friction, Tension, and Normal Force
- Wk 6** Free-Body Diagrams and Force Analysis
- Wk 7** Force and Acceleration: Complex Systems
- Wk 8** Forces in Real-World and Multi-Step Contexts
- Wk 9** Quarter 1 Assessment

Quarter 2 — Weeks 10–18

- Wk 10** Momentum, Collisions, and Conservation of Momentum
- Wk 11** Work, Power, and Kinetic Energy
- Wk 12** Potential Energy and Conservation of Energy
- Wk 13** Energy: Cross-Topic Applications
- Wk 14** Heat and Thermal Physics: Temperature and Specific Heat
- Wk 15** Calorimetry, Phase Changes, and Quantitative Reasoning
- Wk 16** Heat Transfer: Conduction, Convection, and Radiation
- Wk 17** Gravitation: Universal Gravitation and Orbital Motion
- Wk 18** Quarter 2 Assessment

What a Typical Week Looks Like

Readings & Lessons

- READ** Readings and lesson pages in Canvas covering the week’s science concept
- NOTEBOOK** Science notebook entries: observations, models, and evidence-based explanations
- DISC** Discussion post responding to a science question, plus replies to classmates

Assignments & Assessments

- LAB/MODEL** Investigation, model, or digital activity applying the week’s concept
- QUIZ** Reading or lesson comprehension quiz
- EXAM** Unit exam at the conclusion of each unit; honors-level extended response required

Weekly Time Commitment

- Class meets **5 days/week**, totaling **250 minutes of instruction** per week
- Estimated additional independent work: **1–2 hours/week**
- Notebook entries and discussions typically due mid-week; quizzes by Friday

What Students Need

- Reliable internet access and a Canvas-compatible device
- A Canvas account (provided by the school)
- Science notebook (physical or digital) for observations and notes
- All readings and resources provided in Canvas — no textbook purchase required

On-Demand Students

Work through modules at your own pace within the semester window. Deadlines appear in Canvas — aim to complete at least one section per day. Reach your teacher via Canvas messages.

Live School Students

Follow a structured weekly schedule with live sessions. Readings open Monday; discussions due Wednesday; labs and quizzes due Friday. Attend live sessions and check Canvas daily.